Udhaar Ledger: a decision layer for distributor credit

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This case study argues that late collections at Indian SME distributors are mainly a credit-allocation problem, not a reminder problem: credit is granted at sale time by people who do not bear its cost. It proposes a decision layer on top of Tally or Excel rather than another ledger app. No distributor has been interviewed yet, so every claim carries an evidence tag.

Executive summary

Start with a ranked, explainable daily collection list and an outcome log, read from the distributor's existing Tally or Excel books. Do not start with another ledger app, a lender or a hard credit gate.

The problem. Distributors sell largely on credit to retailers, and public sources suggest credit and collections run on memory, printed outstanding reports and phone calls. **Reported (vendor sources); the workflow itself is a Hypothesis**

The insight. "Late payment" sits on three gaps: how much credit each retailer gets (allocation), how early slipping behaviour is seen (information), and where the owner's limited call time goes (attention). Reminders and fixed credit limits are already sold by others: Tally holds a per-party limit and raises an error when a voucher exceeds it, and OkCredit sends WhatsApp and SMS reminders. In the pages I read, no product is documented as ranking whom to chase, explaining why in plain words, or logging call outcomes. That is the wedge, and it stays a hypothesis until each product is tried hands-on.

Decision	Reasoning
Lead with Chase; add Gate second	Limit enforcement already exists in Tally and in billing systems, so it is a weak differentiator. Ranking with reasons, plus an outcome log, is the part I could not find documented.
Read from Tally and Excel; never replace the books	Replacing accounting software is the largest adoption barrier. Whether data can be extracted reliably is untested.

Decision	Reasoning
Rules before machine learning	There is no outcome data yet, owners must be able to overrule the list, and a stability check shows the ranking holds as a tier, not as an exact order.
Test annual prices of ₹5,000–12,000	Tally's own Silver rental is ₹8,100 a year, so a ₹2,000-a-month add-on would cost more than the ledger it sits on. My first draft's range was too high.
Leave out lending, pooled retailer scoring, automated retailer messages and an own payment rail	Each adds capital, regulatory or trust cost that this case has no evidence to carry.

What this case establishes, and what it does not. Desk research supports the Section 43B(h) payment rule (**Verified**), Tally's limit feature and pricing (**Reported**, from Tally's own pages), and the fact that credit terms vary widely by category: sources range from 7–14 days to 30–60 days. It does not establish that owners want a ranking or will follow it, that a ranking beats their own judgement, that they will pay, that Tally data can be extracted cleanly, or that lateness is concentrated enough for ranking to matter.

Size. An industry association cited by PTI reports 4.5 lakh distributors across all trades (**Reported**). I assume about 4,00,000, of which 25% (100,000) run general-trade credit on computerised books and fit the product (**Assumptions**). At 0.5–2% adoption and ₹5,000–12,000 a year, subscription revenue is about ₹25 lakh–₹2.4 crore a year (Section 4). That supports a very small team. It does not support a venture-scale case on subscriptions alone.

Biggest risks. Willingness to pay at this category's price anchors; getting clean data out of Tally; and the owner's trust in a ranked list.

Next. Section 11 sets out a 90-day plan that needs no customer access: hands-on trials of competing products, a Tally and Excel importer, a transparent scoring prototype with its stability and backtest checks, and a legal review of the data-protection questions in Section 9 before any pilot.

How to read this

Every claim is tagged, so a reader can see how much weight it carries.

Tag	Meaning
Verified	Confirmed across several independent sources, such as the dates and limits of a tax rule.
Reported	One named source says so and I have not checked it independently. Marketing claims are marked "vendor".
Assumption	A number or fact I chose so the reasoning can proceed. Replace it when better data exists.
Hypothesis	A belief about distributors that interviews should confirm or kill.

Much of the public evidence on this topic is vendor blogging, and some figures conflict. I left out claims that state no method, such as a vendor's "40% of new distributors fail within 3 years".

Author's vantage point. I have spent 4+ years part-time supporting my family's superstockist and distributorship business, which spans several districts and tracks sales and collections in Excel. That gives me a close view of one business, and a bias toward generalising from it.

Everything below about how that business works is therefore a **Hypothesis** until other distributors confirm or contradict it.

1. Problem: what is broken, and why

The visible symptom is late payment. The likely root cause is that credit is granted and chased without a written policy, an early signal or a priority order. **Hypothesis**

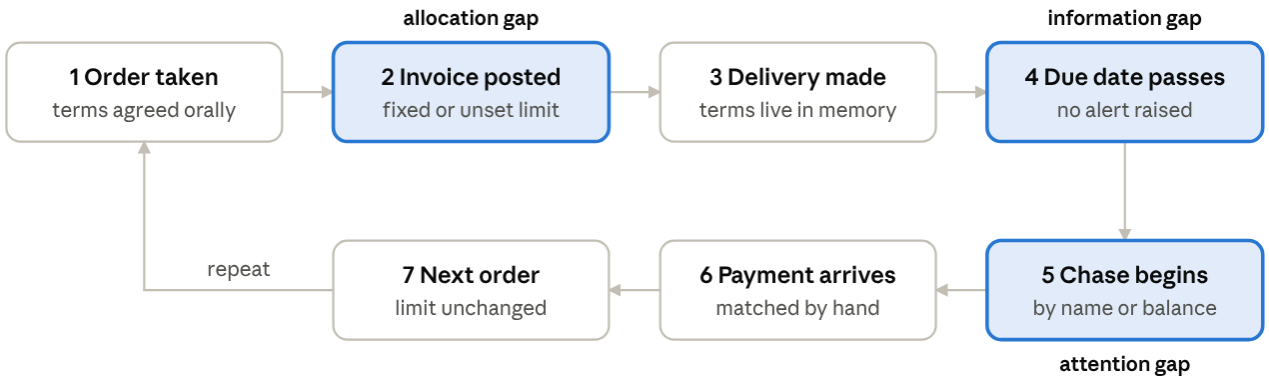
The workflow today

This is reconstructed from public sources and my own context, not observed across distributors. **Hypothesis**

1. A salesman takes an order and promises credit, often verbally.
2. The invoice is posted to Tally or Excel. Tally can hold a credit limit per party, but I found no evidence on how often distributors set or enforce one, and a fixed limit says nothing about changing behaviour.
3. Goods are delivered. The retailer owes on terms that live in memory ("next week").
4. The due date passes silently. Ageing exists only in an outstanding report the accountant prints or exports.

5. The owner or accountant chases from that report, sorted by party name or balance, by phone and WhatsApp.
6. Payment arrives by cash, UPI or cheque and is matched to invoices by hand.
7. The next order is taken with no change to the credit decision.

Three of seven steps are blind spots in the collections loop



Shaded steps are where the gaps sit. Reconstructed from sources, not observed.

today's collections loop · 7 steps, 3 gaps

The credit limit is fixed or unset at invoicing, the due date raises no alert, and the chase order ignores what is recoverable. **Hypothesis**

What the evidence supports

Claim	Source	Tag
Credit decisions drift from the owner to salespeople as a business scales	RetailPOS blog (search excerpt; page not opened)	Reported (vendor)
Over-limit deliveries continue because the salesman wants his billing number	ShelfLifePro guide (search excerpt)	Reported (vendor)
Most distributors work from a printed Tally outstanding statement, by phone and WhatsApp	Takkada blog (search excerpt; Takkada sells a rival tool)	Reported (vendor)
Up to 90% of distributor-to-retailer sales are on credit	OkCredit, which names no source for the figure	Reported (company)

Claim	Source	Tag
Distributors judge credit on years of knowing a retailer's family, seasons and reputation	Vanik blog, May 2026	Reported (commentary)
Credit has become a primary lever for winning kirana purchases	YourStory, Jan 2026, quoting Flipkart Wholesale's head	Reported (company)

Every row comes from a seller, a competitor or a commentator with something to sell. None is independent data, which is itself a finding: public, neutral data on distributor receivables looks thin. Two vendors give bad-debt ranges that differ (0.25–1% and 1.5–3% of turnover, the second for manually run distributors), and neither states a method.

What secondary research adds. Credit terms differ widely by source and category: 7–14 days in the IIMB study's grocery setting, about 30 days in fashion, and 30–60 days in a Kotak Neo note on FMCG distributors (all **Reported**). So "late" only has meaning against each account's agreed terms, which is why Section 8 measures against terms. An IBSi report on a Recordent survey headlines that 52% of B2B payments in Indian cities were overdue by 90 days; I read it as context only, since I did not see its method (**Reported**). Why retailers pay late is still not established by any source I read, so the five whys below stay **Hypotheses**.

Five whys

Why	Answer	Tag
Why is money overdue?	Retailers pay when their own cash arrives, and paying late costs them nothing.	Hypothesis
Why does it cost nothing?	Terms are informal and unenforced, and the next order matters more than the last payment.	Hypothesis
Why does the order win?	Salespeople are rewarded for billing, and credit is decided by someone who does not bear the loss.	Reported (vendor)
Why is the credit decision weak?	The owner's judgement of each retailer is tacit and does not travel when decisions are delegated.	Hypothesis

Why	Answer	Tag
Why does the owner not see trouble coming?	Tools record what happened but do not flag a change in behaviour or rank who to act on.	Hypothesis

Root cause

Three gaps sit under the symptom:

- **Allocation:** how much credit each retailer gets is not a written, enforced rule.
- **Information:** a retailer's slipping payment behaviour is invisible until it is overdue.
- **Attention:** the owner's limited call time goes to lists sorted by name or balance, not by what is recoverable.

Reminders address none of these directly. They are table stakes, and several products already sell them (see Landscape).

The objective is not the lowest possible DSO

Chasing harder has a cost: retailers can buy elsewhere, and platforms now compete on credit. The right objective is margin after bad debt, cost of capital and lost retailers. A product that cuts overdue balances by losing good customers has failed. **Hypothesis**

2. Users: who feels the problem

The owner-distributor bears the loss, the accountant does the chasing and the salesman creates the credit. A product must serve all three without giving any of them a reason to ignore it. **Hypothesis**

No distributor has been interviewed for this case. The archetypes below are working hypotheses built from public sources and my own context, followed by fictional personas that illustrate them. They are the first thing the validation plan tests.

Archetype	Needs	Likely behaviour	Frustration	Motivation
Owner-distributor (buyer, decides credit)	A morning view of who owes what, and credit calls he can trust	Judges credit by relationship; chases big accounts himself and hands the rest on	Cannot see credit given by others; cannot be everywhere	Protect a thin margin and keep retailers loyal

Archetype	Needs	Likely behaviour	Frustration	Motivation
Accountant or munim (daily user)	A short, clear list to work from	Prints the Tally outstanding report; calls and WhatsApps in bulk; matches payments by hand	Same long list every day; no authority to refuse credit	Keep books clean; avoid conflict with salesmen
Salesman or field executive (creates the credit)	Orders closed and targets hit	Promises credit to win the order	Blamed for ageing he cannot control; fears losing the retailer	Billing target or incentive; his own retailer relationships
Retailer, usually a kirana	Stock now, payment when cash comes in	Pays after strong sales days or festivals; stretches in lean weeks; has other suppliers	Repeated reminders feel like distrust	Keep the shelf full and the credit line open

The brand or its area sales manager is a stakeholder, not a user: a distributor's overdue balances limit what he can buy and pay upstream. **Hypothesis**

Illustrative personas (fictional)

The people below are invented. I made them up to turn the archetypes into something concrete and to walk the product through a day. They are not interview participants, they say nothing about real distributors, and no conclusion in this case rests on them. **Hypothesis**

Persona	Setup	A typical morning today	What the product would change
Ramesh Gupta, owner	General-trade FMCG distributor, about 300 retailers, 6 salesmen, Tally books	Reads the printed outstanding report and calls the biggest names first	Sees only the two accounts that need his decision, each with a reason he can overrule

Persona	Setup	A typical morning today	What the product would change
Sunita Verma, accountant	Eight years with the firm; prints the Tally report and calls in bulk	Works down a long list sorted by party name, then matches payments by hand	Gets a short "Call today" list with reasons and logs each outcome in one tap
Imran Sheikh, salesman	Handles about 40 retailers; paid partly on billing	Promises credit from memory to close the order	Sees the limit and a traffic light at order time and records the promised pay date in one tap
Anil Kirana Store, retailer	Small shop that pays after strong weekend sales	Gets the same reminder as everyone else, which feels like distrust	Is contacted less often and at better-judged moments, because of the contact cooldown

A Tuesday in this fictional business. Sunita opens the Today screen from Section 7, using the nine invented accounts from Section 6. Three go to **Call today**: Specimen Mart (₹95,000, 12 days late, usually pays when asked), Big Self-Payer (₹2,00,000, 9 days late, usually pays on its own) and Example Kirana (₹48,000, 35 days late, missed a promise). Demo Stores and Placeholder Co, both unresponsive, go to **Escalate** for Ramesh to decide on a visit or a supply hold. Sample Traders has a disputed invoice and goes to **Resolve**. Sorted by balance, her first three calls would have been Big Self-Payer, Sample Traders and Demo Stores. Putting Big Self-Payer in Call today is a known weakness of the score (see the failure modes in Section 6), and whether this order recovers more rupees than the balance list is exactly what real data must show.

Who to design for first

The first customer is a general-trade distributor with roughly 100–500 retailers, 3–10 salesmen and Tally or Excel books. **Assumption**

The reasoning: such a firm is large enough that the owner no longer makes every credit call, which is where the RetailPOS source says control breaks. It is small enough that the owner still cares personally and buys the tool himself. The size band is my guess and should be re-cut after interviews.

Journey from order to re-evaluation

Stage	Who acts	Pain	Opening for the product
1. Order	Salesman	Credit promised without seeing the retailer's history	Show the limit and a traffic light at order time
2. Invoice	Accountant	Over-limit invoices still post	Flag them and ask for a reason code, without blocking
3. Delivery	Salesman or delivery staff	Terms live in memory, so disputes come later	Record the promised pay date on the invoice
4. Due date	Nobody	The first miss goes unnoticed	Alert on the first miss and on a rising average of days late
5. Chase	Owner or accountant	List sorted by name or balance; one message for everyone	A ranked daily list with a reason and a suggested action
6. Settlement	Accountant	Hand matching of cash, UPI and cheques	Leave to existing tools; import the result
7. Re-evaluation	Owner	Limits are rarely revisited	Suggest limit changes monthly from observed behaviour

All rows are **Hypothesis**. Stage 6 is deliberately not an opening: matching payments is a solved problem for the tools listed next.

Job to be done (Hypothesis). When credit I gave is slipping, help me decide in a few minutes whom to approach today, so that I recover cash without losing the retailer. Design implication: the owner needs reasons he can overrule, the accountant needs a short list and one-tap logging, and the salesman needs a signal that does not block his order.

3. Landscape: what already exists

Recording, reminding and collecting are well served. The least-served step looks like deciding who gets credit and whom to chase first. **Hypothesis**, based on vendor descriptions I read, not on hands-on use of the products.

Category	Examples	What it does for this problem	Likely gap	Tag
Ledger apps	Khatabook, OkCredit, Vyapar	Record credit, send reminders, collect by UPI. OkCredit creates a shared ledger when both sides use it (OkCredit; Khatabook listing)	Built for any small merchant; no credit policy at order time or recoverability ranking described	Reported (company)
Accounting and ERP	Tally, Marg, Busy	Hold the books and outstanding reports. Marg lists WhatsApp reminders (reseller page)	Record what happened; do not appear to rank who to act on	Reported
Collection layers on Tally	Takkada and similar	Reminder cadence, UPI link per invoice, receipts posted back to Tally (Takkada blog)	Strong on reminders and reconciliation; ranking and credit policy not described	Reported (vendor)
Distribution management systems	SpireStock, SalesPort, Bizom	Hard credit limits at invoice generation (SpireStock)	Some are brand-facing, but RetailPOS is sold to distributors. Hard limits at invoicing are common, so a credit gate is not new; a ranked worklist is not described in what I read	Reported (vendor)

Category	Examples	What it does for this problem	Likely gap	Tag
B2B marketplaces with credit	Udaan, Flipkart Wholesale, Jumbotail	Udaan began lending on its platform in Nov 2018 (KrASIA); Flipkart Wholesale says credit is now a primary lever (YourStory)	They compete for the retailer; a distributor who cannot extend credit well risks losing him	Reported
Bank rails	Credit line on UPI	Pre-sanctioned bank credit usable through UPI (NPCI); extended to small finance banks in Feb 2025 (Business Standard)	Not receivables management; business-to-business use was not confirmed in what I read	Reported

What this means

- **Do not compete on reminders.** Several vendors sell them and ledger apps give them away. They are an integration, not a differentiator.
- **Compete on the decision.** The open space is a ranked, explainable daily list with outcome logging. Order-time limits already exist in Tally and billing systems. **Hypothesis**
- **Expect incumbents to follow.** Tally or a ledger app could add ranking. The defence is data they do not collect: promised pay dates, override reasons and call outcomes. **Hypothesis**
- **Check before building.** Absence from a vendor's marketing is not proof of absence. I would trial each product hands-on first.

4. Prioritisation: why this problem

Credit and collections scores highest of six candidate distributor problems on a simple rubric. The scores are my judgement and should be redone after interviews. **Assumption**

Severity is the hit to margin or survival. Frequency is how often it occurs. Tractability is whether a small team can build and get it adopted without brand integration. Whitespace is how little existing products cover it. Each is scored 1–5 with equal weight.

Candidate problem	Severity	Frequency	Tractability	Whitespace	Total of 20
Credit decisions and collections	5	5	4	3	17
Beat planning	3	5	3	2	13
Scheme and claim leakage	4	4	2	3	13
Expiry and returns	3	3	3	3	12
Secondary sales data trust	3	4	2	2	11
GST input-credit lock-up	3	3	1	2	9

The GST row reflects expert comments that input credit accumulates for distributors after a 2025 circular (Business Standard, PTI). It scores low on tractability because the fix is policy, not product.

Why credit hurts: the arithmetic

Vendor sources put distributor net margins at 1–6%, most at 2–4% (SpireStock, search excerpt; page not opened). **Reported (vendor)**

- **Bad debt is expensive to earn back.** At 4%, 3% and 2% net margin, a single ₹1 lakh write-off takes ₹25 lakh, about ₹33 lakh and ₹50 lakh of sales to recover. My arithmetic on the vendor range.
- **Slow credit has a carrying cost.** The same vendor's example: ₹20 lakh of monthly sales with 15 extra days of credit ties up ₹10 lakh and costs ₹10,000–12,000 a month. That implies about 12–14% a year, by my arithmetic.
- **Credit is the norm.** OkCredit says up to 90% of distributor-to-retailer sales are on credit, with no source given (OkCredit). **Reported (company)**

Why now

- **Credit is how platforms win retailers.** Flipkart Wholesale's head says credit has moved from a support feature to a primary lever. Distributors need sharper credit calls to compete. **Reported (company)**; the implied need is a **Hypothesis**.
- **A tax rule may squeeze payables.** Section 43B(h), effective 1 April 2024, lets a buyer deduct a purchase from a micro or small enterprise only if it is paid within 15 days, or 45 days with a written agreement. Otherwise the deduction waits until payment (L&T

Finance). **Verified** across several sources. Whether it reaches trading firms was not confirmed in what I read, so the idea of a payables-against-receivables calendar is a **Hypothesis** to check with a chartered accountant.

- **UPI credit lines are a watch item, not a dependency.** They exist for individuals and small merchants. I found no confirmation of business-to-business use. **Reported**

How big is it? A sensitivity, not a forecast

An industry association cited by PTI says it represents 4.5 lakh distributors (Business Standard). **Reported** That figure spans all trades, so I start lower: about 4,00,000 distributors, of which I assume 25% (100,000) run general-trade credit on computerised books and fit the product. All of these are **Assumptions**, as are adoption and price. Annual revenue = 100,000 × adoption × annual price.

The table varies adoption and annual price; every input is an **Assumption**.

Adoption (distributors)	₹5,000 a year	₹8,000 a year	₹12,000 a year
0.5% (500)	₹25 lakh	₹40 lakh	₹60 lakh
1% (1,000)	₹50 lakh	₹80 lakh	₹1.2 crore
2% (2,000)	₹1 crore	₹1.6 crore	₹2.4 crore

On these assumptions, subscription revenue is ₹25 lakh–₹2.4 crore a year: a very small business, enough for a small team at best. Larger upside would need adjacent revenue, such as payment fees or lender and brand partnerships. Each adds regulatory or conflict-of-interest risk, so all are out of scope for version 1.

Decision

Pursue credit and collections, but as decision support, not record-keeping. The riskiest assumption is willingness to pay. It is the first thing to test.

5. Solution: what to build, and what not to

Build a decision layer that reads from Tally or Excel and does two jobs: rank each day's collection calls by what is recoverable (built first), and apply a transparent, advisory credit rule at order time (built second). **Hypothesis**

Alternatives considered

Option	What it is	For	Against	Verdict
A. Better ledger and reminders	A digital khata with automated reminders	Fast to build; demand for reminders is proven	Commodity, with free rivals; treats the symptom	Reject as the core; integrate it
B. Hard credit limits at billing	Block invoices above a limit	Direct control; DMS vendors sell it	Invites bypass and lost sales; needs billing integration	Reject as default; start soft
C. Decision layer: credit rule plus ranked worklist	A transparent policy, a daily ranked call list, logged outcomes	Targets all three gaps; light integration; builds decision data	Needs a behaviour change; a bad ranking costs trust	**Recommend**
D. Lending to retailers	Fund retailer credit through a lender	Largest revenue pool	Capital and regulation heavy; one commentator argues Udaan's credit outgrew its risk intelligence (Vanik)	Out of scope
E. Credit dashboards for brands	Sell distributor risk views upstream	Brands can pay	Conflicts with serving the distributor	Out of scope

The recommended product: three loops

All three loops are **Hypothesis**.

1. **Rule.** The owner sets a credit policy per retailer segment: limit, terms and grace days. Defaults come from each retailer's past payments in the imported data.
2. **Gate.** The first release only reports invoices posted above the limit; reason codes follow. Later versions show a traffic light and the remaining limit to the salesman at order time. Going over is allowed but costs one tap and leaves a record.

3. **Chase.** Each morning the owner or accountant gets a ranked call list with the reason each retailer is there and a suggested first action. Outcomes (paid, promised date, dispute, unreachable) are logged in one tap.

The ranking rule is specified, with weights, lanes, a worked example on invented data and failure modes, in Section 6. It is not validated.

Why plain rules before machine learning. There is no outcome data yet, owners must trust and overrule the list, and a transparent rule avoids unexplained scoring of small shopkeepers. Learning from logged outcomes comes later.

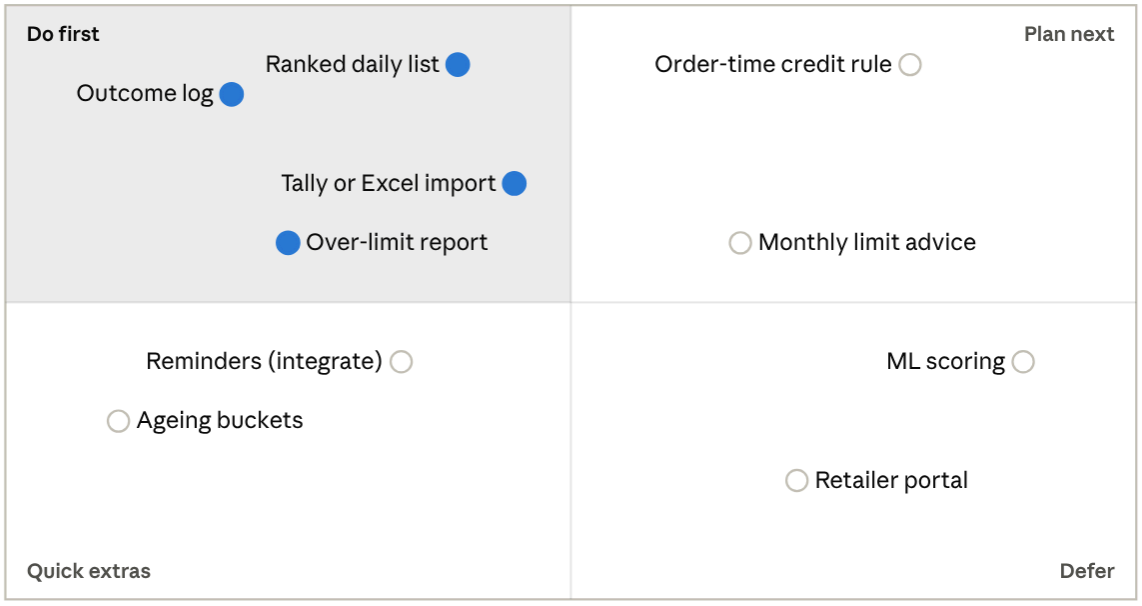
Why read from Tally instead of replacing it. Distributors already keep books there, and replacing them is the largest adoption barrier. Import effort from Tally and Excel exports is unverified and is a first technical test. **Assumption**

Feature priority

Placement reflects my judgement of value to the owner against effort to build. It should be redrawn after interviews.

Four features carry the first release

Higher means more value to the owner. Further right means more effort to build.



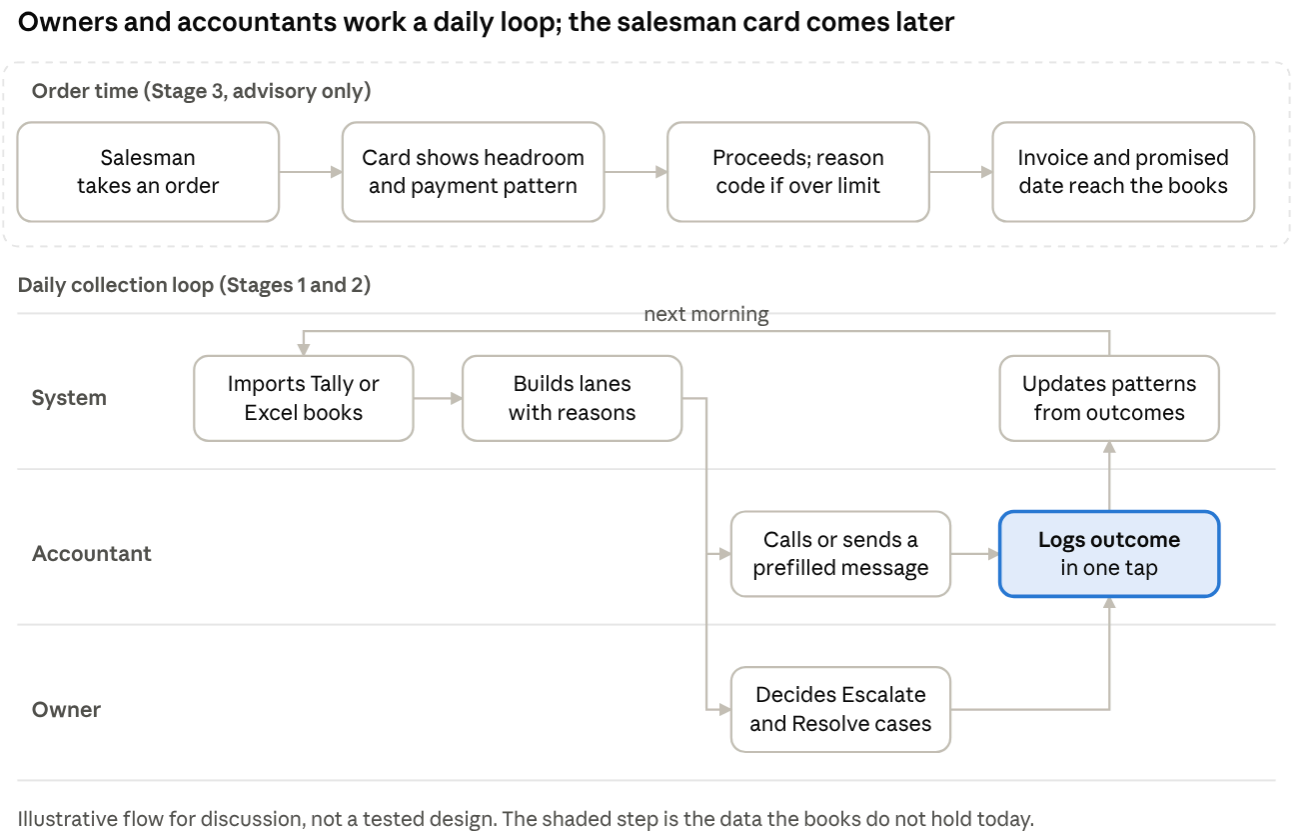
feature priority · value against effort, 10 items

The first release is the outcome log, the ranked list, the import and the over-limit report. The order-time rule is the heart of the fix for the allocation gap, but it needs a salesman-facing surface, so it follows once the list earns trust.

What is deliberately left out

- **Lending or credit sold to retailers.** Capital and regulatory weight, and the Udaan caution above.
- **Our own payment rail.** Collect through UPI links from existing tools.
- **Billing, inventory or GST.** Tally keeps those books; the product reads them.
- **Automatic invoice blocking in version 1.** A block risks lost sales and invites workarounds. Advisory first.
- **Frequent or shaming messages to retailers.** The relationship is the distributor's main asset.
- **A black-box credit score.** Transparent rules only.
- **Sharing data with brands, banks or lenders.** Trust with the owner comes first.
- **A retailer-facing app.** It adds a second adoption problem before the first is solved.

To-be workflow



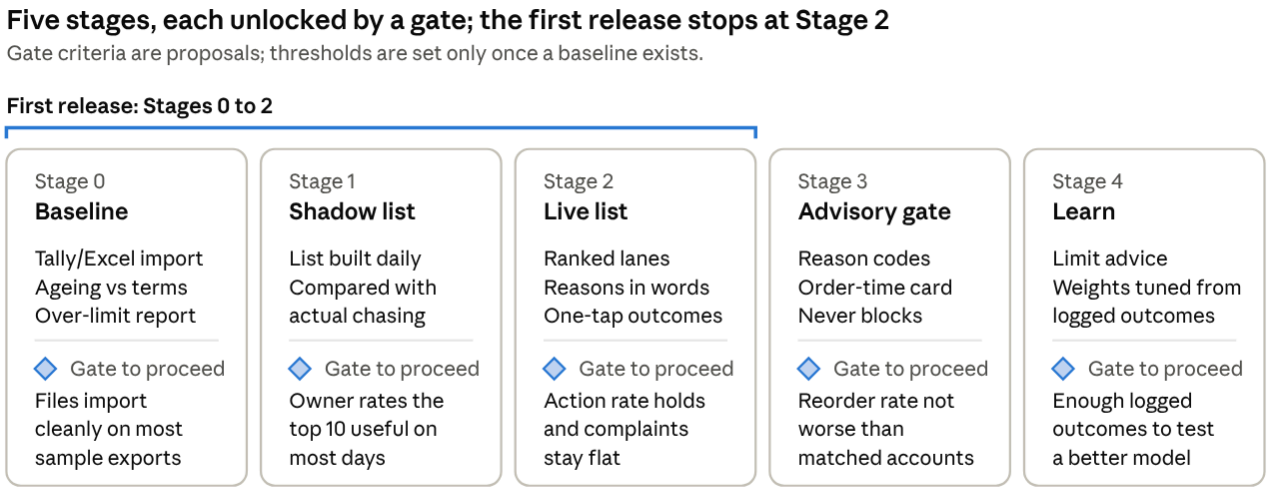
Illustrative flow for discussion, not a tested design. The shaded step is the data the books do not hold today.

to-be workflow · order time and daily loop, 3 lanes

The owner and accountant work a daily loop. The salesman's card is a later, advisory layer. Every row can be pinned, skipped or marked paid, so the owner stays in control.

Hypothesis

MVP sequencing



MVP sequence · 5 stages, 5 gates

Stage	Ships	Why in this order
0. Baseline	Importer, ageing relative to terms, over-limit report, baseline metrics	Everything depends on clean invoice and receipt data, and impact cannot be judged without a baseline
1. Shadow list	A daily list that is built but not acted on, compared with what the accountant actually chased	Tests the ranking logic and surfaces data errors without changing behaviour
2. Live list	Lanes, reasons and one-tap outcome logging	The outcome log starts the data that later stages learn from
3. Advisory gate	Reason codes, then the order-time card	Limit enforcement already exists elsewhere, it needs a salesman-facing surface, and over-blocking loses sales
4. Learn	Limit advice and weight tuning from logged outcomes	Needs enough logged outcomes to test against the rule

I set no numeric gate thresholds until a baseline exists. A threshold chosen before seeing real data is a guess presented as a standard.

Trade-offs behind the decisions

Decision	Chosen	Rejected	What it gives up	Revisit when
Limits	Advisory flag with a reason code	Hard block at billing	Immediate control	Over-limit invoices stay high after Stage 3 and losses concentrate in overrides
Ranking logic	Transparent rules	Machine-learned score	Predictive power from day one	Enough outcomes are logged and a backtest beats the rule
Data	Read from Tally and Excel	Replace the books	Control of the data model	Exports prove too unreliable
Messaging	Prefilled messages sent from the accountant's own WhatsApp	Automated reminders from a platform number	Scale and automation	Users ask for it and per-message costs are known
Output	Tiers and lanes	Numbered ranks	Apparent precision	Stability improves (see Section 6)
Data scope	One distributor's own data	Pooled retailer reputation across distributors	A network effect	Legal basis, consent and trust are settled
First user	Owner and accountant	Salesman	Reach at the point where credit is created	The list has earned trust

WhatsApp charges per template message on its business platform from 1 July 2025 (Meta documentation); I could not obtain India rates, so I treat messaging cost as unknown. **Reported**

6. The ranking model: transparent, explainable, and honest about its limits

The model estimates how much a call today is worth, not how risky a retailer is. A large balance owed by someone who pays on their own is a poor use of a phone call, and an account that never answers needs a different action altogether. **Hypothesis**

Design principles

- **Rank by the benefit of acting, not by risk.** Risk tells the owner who might default. The daily question is whom to spend time on.
- **Lanes before ranks.** Some accounts need a call, some a decision by the owner, some a dispute resolved. Mixing them in one list hides that.
- **Every row explains itself in words and can be overruled.** The owner must be able to disagree with the list and leave a trace.

The score

```
\text{score} = \text{overdue rupees} \times R \times W \times C
```

Term	Meaning	Values used in the example
Overdue rupees	Amount past due on undisputed invoices	From the books
R, response factor	How much a call is likely to change the outcome, given the retailer's pattern	Pays when asked 1.0; thin history 0.7; missed a promise 0.6; pays on its own 0.4; unresponsive 0.3
W, age weight	Recoverability by days past due	1–7 days 0.5; 8–30 days 1.0; 31–60 days 1.2; 61–90 days 0.9; over 90 days 0.5
C, contact cooldown	Avoids repeat calls	0.5 if contacted in the last 3 days, otherwise 1.0

Every value is my **Assumption**. The shape of W (early lateness often corrects itself and the odds fall with age) is ordinary collections reasoning, but I found no source for these numbers.

Patterns come from the distributor's own books:

- **Pays when asked:** paid within 7 days after a logged contact in most recent cases. Needs the outcome log.

- **Pays on its own:** paid within 7 days of the due date with no logged contact. Derivable from the import.
- **Missed a promise:** a logged promised date passed unpaid in the last 60 days. Needs the log.
- **Unresponsive:** two or more logged contacts with no response. Needs the log.
- **Thin history:** fewer than three settled invoices. Derivable from the import.

Stages 0 and 1 can use only the import-derived patterns, which is one more reason the outcome log ships early.

Lane rules

1. A disputed invoice sends the account to **Resolve**. It is not chased until someone clears the dispute.
2. An unresponsive account, or any account more than 90 days past due, goes to **Escalate**. The owner decides: visit, hold supply or settle.
3. The rest are scored. The top N, where N is the number of calls the team can make that day (3 in the example), go to **Call today**. The remainder go to **Message**.

Worked example on invented data

The nine retailers below are invented, and the weights are my assumptions. The example shows the mechanics. It cannot show that the model works.

Retailer	Overdue (₹)	Days past due	Pattern	Rank if sorted by balance	Model lane	Score
Big Self-Payer	2,00,000	9	Pays on its own	1	Call today	80,000
Sample Traders	1,80,000	48	Disputed invoice	2	Resolve	—
Demo Stores	1,20,000	62	Unresponsive	3	Escalate	—
Specimen Mart	95,000	12	Pays when asked	4	Call today	95,000
Placeholder Co	75,000	100	Unresponsive	5	Escalate	—
Test General	60,000	5	Pays on its own	6	Message	12,000
Example Kirana	48,000	35	Missed a promise	7	Call today	34,560
Model Provisions	30,000	40	Pays when asked; called yesterday	8	Message	18,000
New Account	22,000	18	Thin history	9	Message	15,400

Sorted by balance, the first three calls would go to a self-payer, a disputed account and an unresponsive one. The model's three are Specimen Mart, Big Self-Payer and Example Kirana, and the disputed and unresponsive accounts reach the owner as decisions rather than calls. Whether those three recover more rupees than the balance list's three is exactly what real data must show.

Stability check

I varied the five R values, with the other weights fixed, to see how much the output depends on my guesses. The scoring code was run on the six accounts that are scored; the disputed account and the two escalated ones are handled by lane rules, not scores.

Perturbation of R values	Same Call-today set	Same first account
Each up or down by up to 25%, 5,000 random draws	100% of draws	77.5% of draws
Each up or down by up to 50%, 5,000 random draws	90.5% of draws	64.4% of draws

Changing one weight at a time by 25% only reorders the top three: lowering "pays when asked" or raising "pays on its own" puts Big Self-Payer above Specimen Mart. **The ranking is stable as a tier and unstable as an exact order**, so the product shows lanes and tiers, not rank numbers. This tests sensitivity to my weights on six invented scored accounts. It says nothing about accuracy on real ones.

Explainability

Each row is generated from its own factors, so the words always match the score.

- **Row text:** "₹95,000 overdue 12 days. Usually pays when asked. Not contacted for 10 days. Suggested: owner calls today."
- **What would change it:** "Ranks lower if payment arrives, a promise is logged or the account is contacted today."
- **Controls:** pin, skip today, mark already paid, mark disputed. Each is logged and reviewed when tuning weights.

Failure modes

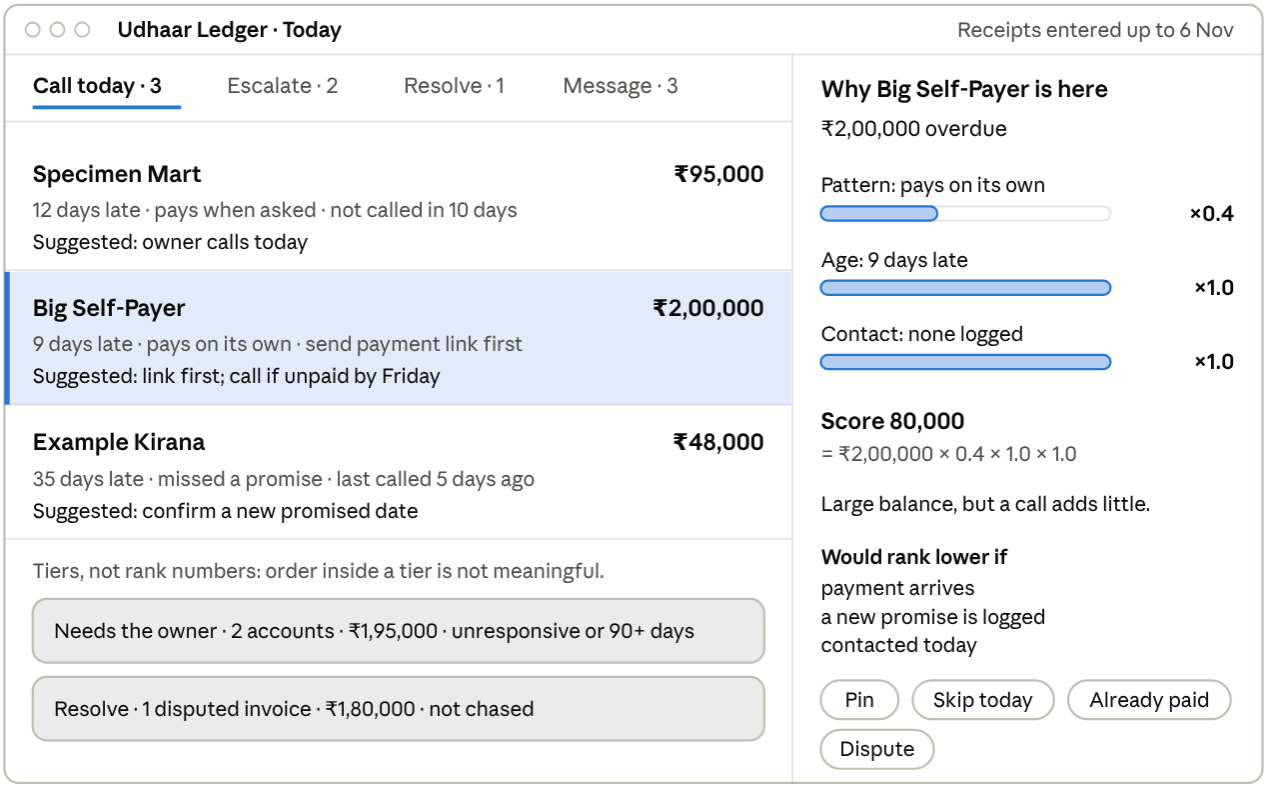
Failure	How it shows	Mitigation
A large balance dominates the score	A self-payer owing ₹2,00,000 outranks a better call (Big Self-Payer is second above)	Test dampening such as the square root of the amount in a backtest; keep the explanation visible
Receipts posted late	Paid retailers appear overdue and trust collapses quickly	One-tap "already paid"; a banner showing days since the last receipt was entered
Cold start	New accounts have no pattern	A default factor with a visible "limited history" label
Self-fulfilling ranking	Low-ranked accounts are never called, so their responsiveness is never learned	Later: reserve one daily slot for accounts outside the top tier, and log it
Unfair treatment of small shopkeepers	Opaque scoring of people with little recourse	Use only payments, promises and contacts in the distributor's own books; show reasons; allow disputes
Logging fatigue	Outcomes not recorded	One tap with defaults; report the share of calls logged
Wrong due date	Informal terms make "late" arguable	Default terms by retailer segment, set once and shown as assumed

7. Product experience

The mock-ups use the invented accounts from Section 6. They are illustrative designs for discussion and have not been tested with any user. **Hypothesis**

Owner and accountant: Today

The owner screen shows tiers, reasons and controls, not a bare ranking

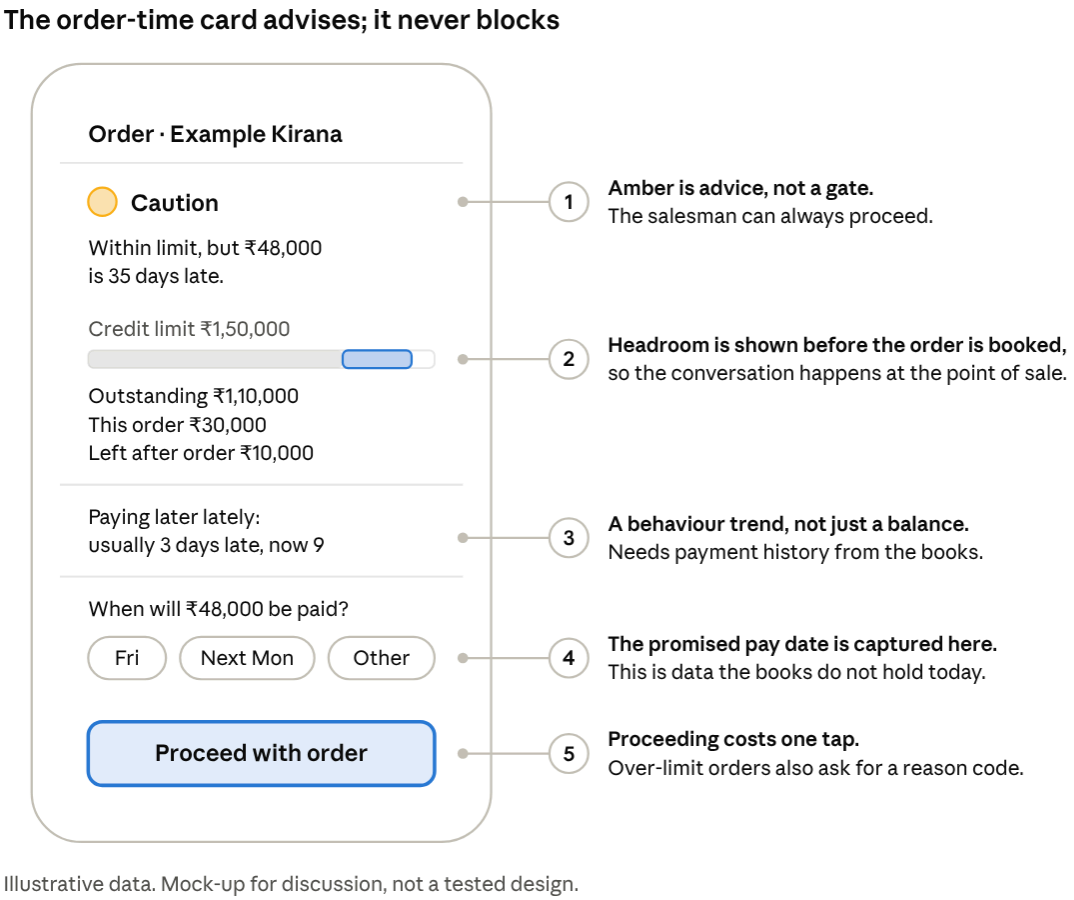


Illustrative data from the worked example. Mock-up for discussion, not a tested design.

owner and accountant screen · Today, with explanation panel

The screen answers one question: whom do I spend today's time on, and why? Lanes separate calls from decisions and disputes. The right-hand panel shows the factors behind any row, and four controls keep the owner in charge. The design choices are tiers instead of rank numbers (the Section 6 stability check), reasons in words, a freshness banner so a stale ledger is visible, and no automated messages to retailers.

Salesman: order-time card



Illustrative data. Mock-up for discussion, not a tested design.

salesman order-time card · phone mock-up with 5 callouts

This card is Stage 3. It gives the order-taker the one piece of information he lacks, and captures the one piece of data the books lack: the promised pay date. It is advisory because a hard block invites workarounds and lost sales, and limit enforcement already exists elsewhere. **Hypothesis**

8. Success metrics: how we would know it works

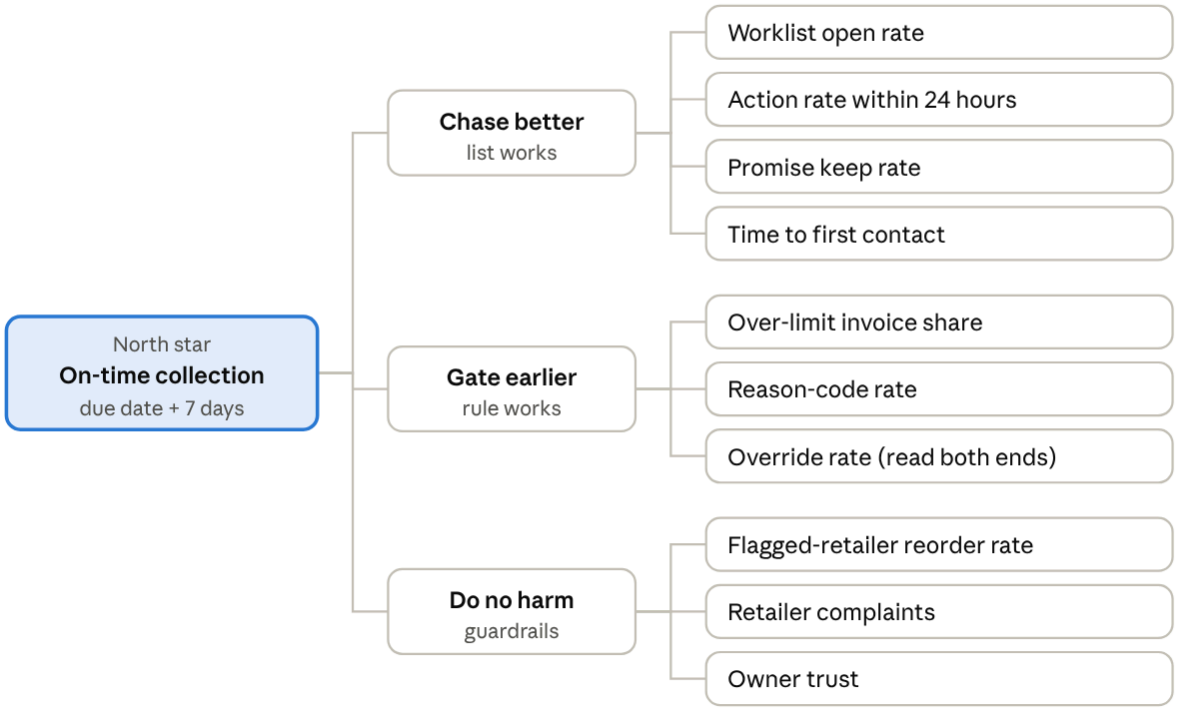
The north star is on-time collection rate: the share of invoiced value collected within seven days of its due date. It measures cash returned on agreed terms, and guardrails stop it from improving at the cost of good retailers. **Hypothesis**

Definition: rupees collected on invoices by due date plus 7 days, divided by rupees of invoices that fell due in the period. It is computed weekly per distributor from imported invoices and receipts. The 7-day window is an **Assumption**.

DSO is not the north star. It swings with seasons and sales mix, and it can be lowered by selling less on credit. It belongs under business outcomes.

One north star, fed by two input branches and checked by guardrails

Targets come after a baseline exists.



metric tree · 1 north star, 3 branches, 10 metrics

The tree shows the product-level metrics. Business outcomes such as overdue balance and bad debt sit above it and move more slowly.

Metric set

Fourteen metrics: the north star, three business outcomes that move slowly, and ten product-level metrics, which are the leaves of the tree above.

Layer	Metric	Definition	Source
North star	On-time collection rate	Collected by due date + 7 days ÷ invoices that fell due	Imported invoices and receipts
Business outcome	Overdue over 30 days	Share of receivables more than 30 days past due	Ageing from imported data
Business outcome	Bad debt	Rupees written off, and as % of turnover, each quarter	Owner's books
Business outcome	DSO	Receivables ÷ credit sales × days in period	Imported data
Chase input	Worklist open rate	Days the list was opened ÷ working days	App events

Layer	Metric	Definition	Source
Chase input	Action rate	Ranked rows with an outcome logged within 24 hours ÷ ranked rows	App events
Chase input	Promise keep rate	Promises paid by the promised date ÷ promises logged	Outcome log and receipts
Chase input	Time to first contact	Median days from due date to first logged contact	Outcome log
Gate input	Over-limit invoice share	Invoices above the limit ÷ all invoices	Imported data and the rule
Gate input	Reason-code rate	Over-limit invoices with a reason ÷ over-limit invoices	App events
Gate input	Override rate	Orders placed after the order-time card warned ÷ orders where it warned	App events
Guardrail	Flagged-retailer reorder rate	Flagged retailers ordering in the next 60 days vs matched unflagged retailers	Imported invoices
Guardrail	Retailer complaints	Retailers who complain or ask to stop reminders, per 100 contacted	Outcome log
Guardrail	Owner trust	Share of top-10 rows the owner rates useful, by one tap each week	App events

Read the override rate at both ends. Near zero may mean the rule is ignored. Very high means the rule does not fit the business.

How it would be measured

- **Baseline first.** Compute every metric from 6–12 months of imported history before any list is shown. Enough history existing is an **Assumption**.
- **Pilot design.** A switchback by week within each distributor, set out in the experiment ladder below. An account-level holdout is a secondary analysis only, because shared team attention contaminates the comparison.
- **Seasonality.** Festival weeks distort collections, so compare against off-weeks and the same weeks a year earlier.

- **Small samples.** A handful of distributors cannot support statistical claims. Results are directional and reported with raw counts.
- **No targets yet.** I will set targets after a baseline exists. I do not borrow vendor claims such as a 30–50% DSO reduction (SpireStock), which state no method.

Metric definitions and edge cases

The north star is only as good as its rules for messy ledgers.

Item	Rule
Due date	The promised date if logged, otherwise the default terms for the retailer's segment, shown as "assumed"
On-account receipts	Applied to the oldest open invoice first unless the accountant allocates them; the unallocated share is reported as a data-quality metric
Partial payments	Counted in rupees, not invoices
Credit notes and returns	Reduce the denominator
Disputed invoices	Excluded from the north star while open and tracked separately, including how long disputes stay open
Advance payments	Not counted as collections until applied to an invoice
Weekly cut-off	An invoice enters a week when its due date plus 7 days falls inside it
Festival weeks	Flagged and compared with the same weeks a year earlier

Instrumentation

Product events: import completed (rows read and rejected), list viewed, row opened, outcome logged (paid, promise with date, dispute, unreachable), pin, skip, already paid, dispute, over-limit invoice flagged, reason code given, and prefilled-message link opened. The last shows intent only, not delivery or reply.

Data-quality measures: days since the last receipt was entered, share of receipts left unallocated, share of invoices with assumed terms, and import rejection rate. If these are poor the list is poor, whatever the model does.

Backtest metrics: the evidence available without customers

Metric	Definition	What it can and cannot tell
Early-warning recall at day 7	Of invoices that ended more than 30 days past due, the share whose account was in Call or Escalate within 7 days of the due date	Whether the lanes would have spotted trouble early. Not whether acting would have helped
Call-lane precision	Of accounts in Call at day 7, the share that went on to be more than 30 days late	A low value means the lane is mostly noise
Concentration	Share of rupees that went more than 30 days late that came from the 20% of accounts with the most late invoices	Whether lateness sits in a minority of accounts, so ranking has something to find (hypothesis H3)
Rank stability	Share of random weight perturbations that leave the Call set unchanged	Sensitivity to my guesses, as in Section 6

In any real ledger, outcomes were shaped by the chasing that actually happened. A backtest can find patterns. It cannot measure causal benefit.

Experiment ladder

Rung	Needs	Question	Method	Pre-set decision rule
0	No customers	Do the mechanics work, and is lateness concentrated enough to rank?	Synthetic data for mechanics; importer on test files; optionally one anonymised ledger with the owner's written consent, labelled as a single case	Proceed if lateness is concentrated and the importer reads the fields the model needs. Thresholds are written before the data is opened
1	Pilot distributors	Is the list trusted?	Shadow mode for 2–4 weeks: compare the list with what was actually chased	Proceed if owners rate the top 10 useful on most days

Rung	Needs	Question	Method	Pre-set decision rule
2	Pilot distributors	Does it change collection?	Switchback: alternate weeks with the list on and off within each distributor, order randomised	Continue if on-time collection is higher in on-weeks at most distributors and guardrails hold
3	More distributors	Does it hold without hand-holding?	Stepped rollout with the same metrics	Ship if effects persist and support load is sustainable

Why a switchback and not an account-level holdout. My first draft randomised newly overdue accounts to list or no list. That is contaminated: the team's time is limited, so showing the list for half the accounts pulls attention from the other half, and the gain on the treated half overstates the net effect. Comparing whole weeks avoids that interference. Its weaknesses are carry-over (a promise made in an on-week and paid in an off-week), festival weeks and few observations. I would use washout weeks and flag festivals.

Sample size. Suppose the outcome were account-level recovery within 14 days, with a 40% baseline (an **Assumption**). Detecting a rise to 50% at 80% power and 5% two-sided significance needs about 389 accounts per arm. A rise to 45% needs about 1,534. A pilot with a handful of distributors may not produce those volumes, and outcomes cluster within a distributor, so I treat pilot results as directional and report raw counts.

Decision rules, fixed before the pilot. Ship if (1) on-time collection is higher in on-weeks at most distributors, (2) the flagged-retailer reorder rate is not lower than that of matched unflagged retailers by more than a margin set in advance, and (3) complaints do not rise. Redesign or stop if owners rate fewer than half of top-10 lists useful. I have no baseline, so "most" and the margin are placeholders. They must become numbers before any data exists, not after.

9. Business feasibility

A product can be right and still not be a business. This section tests whether distributors would pay, what stops them adopting, and what could go wrong. Everything here is desk research and **Assumption** until a distributor says otherwise.

Pricing anchors and what they imply

Anchor	What is published	Reading for Udhaar Ledger
Tally Silver rental	About ₹8,100 a year	The ledger itself costs this much. An add-on priced at ₹2,000 a month would cost three times the ledger
Tally Gold rental	Higher than Silver. The first draft's top price, ₹2,000 a month (₹24,000 a year), matched this rental (Reported, Tally's pricing page)	Too high as an add-on
Tally renewal (TSS)	Annual subscription	Owners already accept an annual renewal habit
TallyPrime with WhatsApp	Reminders sit inside the ledger	The reminder is not a paid differentiator
Accountune, OkCredit	Lower-priced reminder and ledger tools	Floor on what a pure reminder is worth

So the first draft's price range was too high. I now test **₹5,000, ₹8,000 and ₹12,000 a year** (**Assumption**), which keeps the add-on at or below the ledger's own cost for most of the range.

Break-even for the buyer

If a distributor has roughly ₹2–5.5 lakh of overdue balance a year that better chasing could still recover (**Assumption**, not measured), the product must recover:

Annual price	Share of that balance it must recover to pay for itself
₹5,000	0.9–2.5%
₹8,000	1.5–3.9%
₹12,000	2.2–5.9%

The arithmetic is simple and the premise is not: whether that balance exists, and whether a ranked list recovers even a few percent of it, is exactly what Sections 8 and 10 test. Vendor figures for the overdue pool are reported, not verified.

Channel hypotheses

- **Tally and Marg partners and CAs** already touch distributors every year. A referral model is a **Hypothesis**.
- **Trade bodies** (for example chemist and FMCG distributor associations) as a place to show a demo. **Hypothesis**, untested.
- **My own network.** Only with explicit consent, and never as evidence of market demand.

Adoption barriers

Barrier	Why it matters	Early test
Tally data extraction is untested	The product is only as good as the import	Importer on sample exports (Rung 0)
Receipts entered late	Stale data produces a wrong list	Data-quality measures in Section 8
Owner is not the user	The accountant does the daily work and the owner decides	Two-role design in Section 7
Salesman resistance	An order-time card adds friction	Advisory only, never blocking
Price against the licence	See anchors above	Willingness-to-pay conversation at pilot
Time to value	The list is only useful once history is imported	Value on day one from existing history

Privacy and compliance

These are my reading of public material, not legal advice, and a lawyer should review them before any pilot.

- **DPDP Act and Rules 2025.** The distributor is most likely the data fiduciary for its retailers' data and the product its processor. Obligations around notice, purpose limits and retention follow from that. I have not confirmed how the rules apply to small business-to-business ledgers.
- **Data minimisation.** Import only what the model uses: party, invoice, amount, dates, receipts, contacts. No bank data, no personal documents.

- **No cross-distributor pooling in v1.** Pooling retailer payment behaviour across distributors could raise credit-information regulation questions I have not researched. Each distributor sees only its own data.
- **Fairness.** The score never uses caste, religion, gender or location. Any retailer shown a message can see why, and a human always decides.
- **WhatsApp.** Prefilled-message links keep sending in the owner's hands. Any automated sending would need template approval and per-message cost, noted in Section 5.
- **Section 43B(h).** Where a distributor buys from micro and small suppliers, it carries its own 15- or 45-day payment duty. This is a reason to see the whole ledger, not only receivables, but I treat it as a later hypothesis.

Risk register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Early signal
Import fails on real Tally exports	Medium	High	Test on varied sample exports first	Rejection rate on test files
List not trusted	Medium	High	Plain-language reasons, tiers not rank numbers, outcome log	Owners ignore the top tier in shadow mode
No measurable effect on collection	Medium	High	Switchback pilot with pre-set stop rules	On-weeks not better at most distributors
Reminders commoditised by Tally	High	Medium	Lead with ranking and outcome learning, not reminders	Pilot owners say "Tally already does this"
Retailer relationships damaged	Low–medium	High	Advisory only, owner approves every message	Complaints, reorder rate of flagged retailers
Privacy or regulatory objection	Low–medium	High	Minimisation, no pooling, legal review	Counsel flags an issue
Willingness to pay below cost to serve	Medium	Medium	Price tests at ₹5,000–12,000 a year; light-touch onboarding	Pilot owners decline at ₹5,000

10. Validation plan: what would change my mind

Nothing in this case is validated yet. Desk research is done. Interviews, a prototype and hands-on trials of competing products are not. Ten to fifteen interviews should test six hypotheses, each with a result that would kill or reshape the idea.

#	Hypothesis	How to test	Kills or reshapes the idea if
H1	Credit is extended by salesmen above what the owner expects, with no written limit	Ask for the last three times credit exceeded the owner's expectation and who approved it	Owners personally approve almost all credit: the Gate loop weakens, so lean on Chase
H2	Owners pick chase targets by name or balance and would value a ranking	Watch one morning of chasing; ask how each call was chosen	Owners already rank well and lack only time: automate the calling instead
H3	Most of the loss sits in a minority of slow accounts	Review an anonymised ageing report for concentration	Lateness is spread thinly across many accounts: ranking adds little, so change terms instead
H4	Accountants will log call outcomes in one tap	Time an accountant logging ten calls on a mock screen	Logging is refused or abandoned: the decision data never accumulates
H5	Owners will pay ₹5,000–12,000 a year	Ask what they pay for Tally or Marg and what this would be worth, unprompted first; then test ₹5,000, ₹8,000 and ₹12,000 a year	Willingness is below ₹5,000 a year: subscription alone fails, so rethink channel or scope
H6	Tally and Excel exports hold invoice dates and receipts well enough to import	Build an importer on sample exports	Exports lack the fields: onboarding cost is too high

What can be tested now, without customers

Hypothesis	Testable now?	How
H1, H2, H4, H5	No	Need owners and accountants
H3	Only as one consented, anonymised ledger	A single labelled case, not evidence about distributors in general
H6	Yes	Importer on sample Tally and Excel exports

Interview plan

- **Who.** 10–15 distributors across general-trade FMCG, pharma and one other category. Speak to the owner and the accountant at each, plus a few salesmen and 3–5 retailers to learn why they pay late.
- **How.** Ask about the last time something happened, not what they would do. Ask to see an anonymised ageing report. Do not pitch.

Risks

Risks are now in the register in Section 9, with likelihood, impact, mitigation and early signal.

Next steps

Work in this order: (1) competitor trials; (2) importer on sample exports; (3) scoring prototype on synthetic data; (4) an optional single, consented backtest; (5) when field work is possible, owner and accountant conversations, then a shadow pilot, then the switchback. Update every tag in this document as evidence arrives.

11. Recommendation

Decision. Do not build the full product yet. Run a 90-day, desk-based sequence that tests the mechanics and the riskiest assumptions without customers, then move to a shadow pilot as soon as field work is possible.

The reason is that the evidence supports the problem and the shape of the solution, but not the demand. Credit limits and reminders already exist. What no page I read documents is a ranked, explainable daily worklist with outcome logging, and whether owners value that enough to pay is unknown.

Go, reshape or stop

Thresholds are written before looking at any data.

Outcome	Condition
Go to a shadow pilot	The importer reads the fields the model needs from sample exports; lateness in the one consented ledger (if used) is concentrated enough to rank; competitor trials confirm no ranked, explainable worklist
Reshape	A competitor already ships a ranked worklist, or lateness is spread too evenly to rank. Then shift to the outcome log and the accountant's workflow
Stop	The importer cannot read real exports, or owners in shadow mode do not find the top 10 useful on most days

The next 90 days, with no field research

Weeks	Work	Output
1–4	Trial the main competitors (TallyPrime, OkCredit, Khatabook, Marg, Accountune) and record what each does with ageing, reminders and limits	A feature-evidence matrix I have personally checked
3–8	Build the importer on sample Tally and Excel exports	Rejection rate and field coverage
5–10	Build the scoring prototype on synthetic data	Mechanics, stability and lane behaviour
6–10	Optionally backtest one anonymised real ledger, with the owner's written consent	A single labelled case
10–12	Write up results against the pre-set thresholds	Go, reshape or stop decision

When field work becomes possible, the next steps are owner and accountant conversations, then a shadow pilot, then the switchback in Section 8.

What I would tell a founder

The defensible part of this idea is the decision layer: a ranked, explainable list that learns from logged outcomes. The undefended part is everything around it. Lead with that, price below the ledger, and be honest that no outcome here has been validated.

Appendix: what changed in this revision

The first draft's central thesis and structure are intact. These are the places where evidence changed my mind.

Area	First draft	Now	Why
Credit-limit whitespace	Credit not checked at invoicing	Tally documents per-party limits and an error at voucher acceptance	Tally's own help page. The order-time rule is the least differentiated feature; lead with Chase
Landscape DMS row	Distributor tools sold mainly to brands	RetailPOS is distributor-facing	Corrected after reading vendor pages
Market size	₹1.35–21.6 crore	₹25 lakh–₹2.4 crore	Adoption applied to an assumed 100,000 fitting distributors, not all 4.5 lakh
Price	Up to ₹2,000 a month	₹5,000–12,000 a year	A monthly add-on would exceed Tally Silver's annual rental
Pilot design	Random half of accounts held out	Switchback by week	Holdout is contaminated by shared team attention
Ranking display	Rank numbers	Lanes and tiers	Order is stable as a tier, not as an exact rank
Sources	—	IIMB study added; Atradius page had no India data	Credit terms conflict across sources

Sources

Search excerpts are not full pages. Where I could not open the page, the table says so.

Source	Used for	How I read it	Reliability
OkCredit: managing inventory credit	Credit-share claims; how the product handles distributor credit	Opened	Company blog; figures have no stated source
Vanik blog, May 2026	How distributors judge credit; marketplace commentary	Opened	Commentary
L&T Finance: MSME 45-day rule	Section 43B(h)	Opened	Lender explainer; consistent with Cashfree, Business Standard and Tally excerpts
YourStory, Jan 2026	Credit as a growth lever	Opened	Brand-published; Flipkart Wholesale's own view
SpireStock margins and credit limits	Margins, carrying cost, DSO claim, DMS capability	Search excerpt; page fetch blocked	Vendor
RetailPOS	Credit delegation to salespeople	Search excerpt; page fetch blocked	Vendor
ShelfLifePro	Over-limit deliveries	Search excerpt	Vendor
Takkada	Tally-based outstanding workflow; collection tooling	Search excerpts	Vendor, and a competitor
Business Standard, PTI	4.5 lakh distributors; GST input-credit lock-up	Search excerpt	News agency quoting an industry association
KrASIA on Udaan	Udaan lending since Nov 2018	Search excerpt	News
NPCI and Business Standard	Credit line on UPI	Search excerpts	Regulator-linked body and news
OkCredit, Khatabook listing, Marg pricing page	Competitor descriptions	Search excerpts	Company and reseller marketing

Added in this revision

Source	Used for	Status
Tally help: credit limits	Per-party limit and error at voucher acceptance	Opened
Tally pricing pages	Silver rental about ₹8,100 a year	Opened
OkCredit wholesale page, Accountune	Reminder and ledger features, pricing floor	Opened
IIMB study	Credit terms and distributor behaviour	Opened
Kotak Neo note	Distributor credit terms and stress	Opened
IBSi	Overdue B2B payments (Recordent survey), context only	Opened
Meta WhatsApp pricing	Per-message cost	Opened
DPDP Rules (PIB)	Data-protection obligations	Hedged; not legal advice
SpireStock, RetailPOS	Distributor limit features	Search excerpts only; pages not opened